



DIFFERENT DINOSAURS

The word “dinosaur” was first used nearly 200 years ago. There has been an explosion of excitement about them ever since. The huge number of different dinosaur species makes the study of dinosaurs fascinating for everyone. Thousands of bones belonging to hundreds of different dinosaurs have now been discovered. Today, dinosaurs are big business, with millions of dinosaur books and toys on sale in stores.

Dinosaur ancestor

Scientists think that over millions of years, the dinosaurs may have developed from small, agile reptiles like *Marasuchus*. The hips and long legs of this primitive reptile are similar to those of the earliest dinosaurs.



The age of the dinosaurs

Dinosaurs didn't all live at the same time. When one species died out, another came along to take its place. The dinosaur age is split into the Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous periods. The first dinosaurs appeared during the Triassic period, about 251 million years ago.



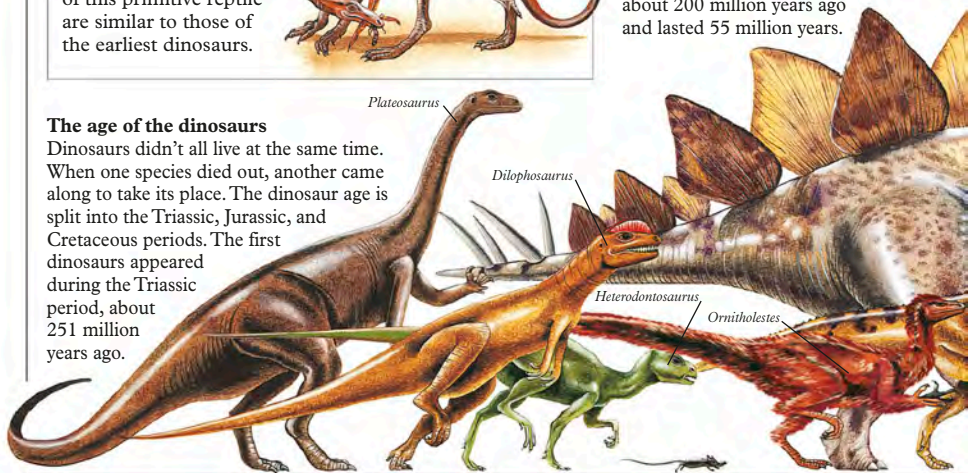
First and last

Herrerasaurus was one of the first dinosaurs. It lived about 251 million years ago. *Tyrannosaurus* was one of the last dinosaurs and became extinct about 67 million years ago. Today, we are closer in time to *Tyrannosaurus* than *Tyrannosaurus* was to *Herrerasaurus*!



Classic Jurassic

The middle part of the dinosaur age is called the Jurassic period. It started about 200 million years ago and lasted 55 million years.



Plateosaurus

Dilophosaurus

Heterodontosaurus

Ornitholestes